MAURICIO ROMERO

CONTACT INFORMATION

Department of Economics
Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México
Río Hondo 1, Altavista
01080 Ciudad de México, CDMX, Mexico

Phone: +52-55-5628-4000 (ext 2965)
Email: mtromero@itam.mx
Website: http://mauricio-romero.com
Twitter: marome1

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Associate Professor	Centro de Investigación Económica, ITAM	2024 –
Visiting Scholar	Department of Economics, Universidad de los Andes	2024 – 2025
Assistant Professor	Centro de Investigación Económica, ITAM	2018 – 2024

EDUCATION

University of California — San Diego	PhD in Economics, 2018
University of California — San Diego	MA in Economics, 2013
Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá, Colombia	BA in Mathematics (Cum Laude), 2010
Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá, Colombia	BA in Economics (Summa Cum Laude), 2009

AFFILIATIONS

Research Affiliate, Jameel Poverty Action Lab, MIT (J-PAL)
Research Affiliate, Innovations for Poverty Action (IPA)
Academic Member, Experiments in Governance and Politics (EGAP)
Non-resident Research Fellow, Center for Global Development (CGD)
Affiliate, The Bureau for Research and Economic Analysis of Development (BREAD)
Research Affiliate, IZA — Institute of Labor Economics

EDITORIAL SERVICE

2025–	Co-Editor, Journal of Development Economics
2022	Guest editor, Economics of Education Review. Special issue on "Education in Low Income Settings"

RELEVANT POSITIONS HELD

Consultant	World Bank	2022
Consultant	UNICEF	2021
Consultant	Innovations for Poverty Action	2020
Consultant	Econometria Consultores	2018 – 2020
Research Assistant	UCSD (Prof. Karthik Muralidharan)	2013 – 2018
Junior Researcher	Quantil | Matemáticas Aplicadas	2009 – 2012
Research Assistant	Universidad de los Andes (Prof. Álvaro Riascos)	2008 – 2009

PUBLICATIONS (PEER-REVIEWED)

"Inputs, Incentives, and Complementarities in Primary Education: Experimental Evidence from Tanzania". **Quarterly Journal of Economics**, Volume 134, Issue 3, 2019. Joint with Karthik Muralidharan, Isaac Mbiti, Youdi Schipper, Constantine Manda, and Rakesh Rajani

"Outsourcing Education: Experimental Evidence from Liberia". **American Economic Review**, Volume 110, No. 2, 2020. Joint with Justin Sandefur and Wayne Sandholtz

"Communal Property Rights and Deforestation". **Journal of Development Studies**, Volume 57, No. 6, 2021. Joint with Santiago Saavedra.

"Local Incentives and National Tax Evasion: The Response of Illegal Mining to a Tax Reform in Colombia". **European Economic Review**, Volume 138, 2021. Joint with Santiago Saavedra.

"Direct vs Indirect Management Training: Experimental Evidence from Schools in Mexico". **Journal of Development Economics**. Volume 154, 2022. Joint with Juan Bedoya, Rafael de Hoyos, Marcela Silveyra, and Monica Yanez-Pagans.

"Cross-Age Tutoring: Experimental Evidence from Kenya". **Economic Development and Cultural Change**, Volume 70, No. 3, 2022. Joint with Lisa Chen and Noriko Magari.

"Beyond Short-term Learning Gains: The Impact of Outsourcing Schools in Liberia after Three Years". **Economic Journal**, Volume 132, No. 644, 2022. Joint with Justin Sandefur.

"Designing Teacher Performance Pay Programs: Experimental Evidence from Tanzania". **Economic Journal**, Volume 133, No. 653, 2023. Joint with Isaac Mbiti and Youdi Schipper.

"Learning Losses during the COVID-19 pandemic: Evidence from Mexico". **Economics of Education Review**. Volume 98, 2024. Joint with Enrique Alasino, María José Ramírez, Norbert Schady and David Uribe.

"The Effect of School Grants on Test Scores: Experimental Evidence from Mexico". **Economica**. Volume 91, No. 363, 2024. Joint with Juan Bedoya, Rafael de Hoyos, Marcela Silveyra, and Monica Yanez-Pagans.

"Factorial Designs, Model Selection, and (Incorrect) Inference in Randomized Experiments". **The Review of Economics and Statistics**. Volume 107, Issue 3, 2025. Joint with Karthik Muralidharan and Kaspar Wuthrich.

"The Productivity of Public and Private Preschools (and Schools): Evidence from India". **Economic Journal**, Volume 136, No. 676, 2026. Joint with Petter Berg and Abhijeet Singh.

"COVID-19 Learning Loss and Recovery: Panel Data Evidence from India". Joint with Abhijeet Singh and Karthik Muralidharan. **Journal of Human Resources**, Volume 61, No. 5, pp. 1499–1535, 2026.

"Preventing School Dropout: Experimental Evidence from Guatemala" Joint with Melissa Adelman, Francisco Haimovich, and Emmanuel Vazquez . **Forthcoming in the Journal of Labor Economics**

"The incidence of affirmative action: Evidence from quotas in private schools in India". Joint with Abhijeet Singh. **Conditionally accepted at the Review of Economic Studies**

COMMENTS, CONFERENCE PROCEEDING, AND OTHERS

"How to make replication the norm". **Nature**. 554: 417–419, 2018. Joint with Paul Gertler and Sebastian Galiani

"Risk Adjustment Revisited using Machine Learning Techniques". **Proceeding Series of the Brazilian Society of Computational and Applied Mathematics**, v. 6, n. 2. 2018. Joint with Álvaro Riascos and Natalia Serna

NON-ECON PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

"On the optimality of answer-copying indices: theory and practice". **Journal of Educational and Behavioral Statistics**. 40: 435–453. 2015. Joint with Álvaro Riascos and Diego Jara

"Misinformation About HIV and Negative Attitudes Toward Homosexuality and Same-Sex Couples' Rights: The Case of Colombia". **International Journal of Public Opinion Research**. Volume 29. Issue 3. pp. 426–448. 2017. Joint with Federico Andrade-Rivas

WORKING PAPERS

"Toxic Recycling: The Cost of Used Lead-Acid Battery Processing in Mexico" Joint with Erin Litzow, Bianca Cecato, and Tatiana Zarate-Barrera. **Reject and resubmit at the Review of Economics and Statistics**

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

"The long term effects of admission to an elite high-school" Joint with Enrique Seira and Rafael de Hoyos

"Improving preschool services: Experimental evidence on a technology-aided intervention in India". Joint with Ajinkya Keskar, Abhijeet Singh and Karthik Muralidharan.

"Designing Teacher Incentives for Scale: Experimental Evidence from Tanzania". Joint with Isaac Mbiti, Youdi Schipper, and Karina Gomez.

"Beyond the experiment: medium-run impacts of a teacher performance pay program in Tanzania". Joint with Isaac Mbiti, Youdi Schipper, and Karina Gomez.

"How much do we gain from personalization? Experimental evidence from Peru". Joint with Raphaelle Aulagnon, Julian Cristia, Nicolas Bottan, and Jose Luis Montiel.

"Air filters and student learning: Experimental evidence from Colombia". Joint with Santiago Saavedra and Michael Kremer.

"Mitigating learning losses during school closures by bridging the digital divide: Experimental evidence from India". Joint with Abhijeet Singh and Karthik Muralidharan.

"Preventing dropout using mentors and information: Experimental evidence from Guatemala". Joint with Martina Jakob, Carla Coccia and Eric Edmonds.

"Targeted instruction with teachers: Experimental evidence from El Salvador". Joint with Martina Jakob and Carla Coccia.

RESTING PAPERS

"Benefit Plans, Insurer Competition, and Pharmaceutical Prices: Evidence from Colombia"

"Using Instrumental Variables under Partial Observability of Endogenous Variables for Assessing Effects of Air Pollution on Health". Joint with Tarik Benmarhnia and Prashant Bharadwaj

"The effect of gold mining on the health of newborns". Joint with Santiago Saavedra

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México

Economics IV	Fall 2018, Spring 2019, Fall 2019, Spring 2020, Spring 2021, Spring 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2023, Fall 2025
Microeconometrics (causal inference & impact evaluation)	Fall 2020, Fall 2021, Spring 2023, Fall 2023, Fall 2025, Spring 2026, Fall 2026
Seminario de Análisis Empírico	Spring 2026, Fall 2026

J-PAL's Evaluating Social Programs

Mechanics of power calculations	June 2021

J-PAL LAC – Impact Evaluation Courses

Impact evaluation course for Comecyt (Estado de México)	2021
Advanced Impact Evaluation Course for INFONAVIT	2024
Impact Evaluation Course for Fundación Pantaleón	2026

EGAP Learning Days

Estimands and estimator in field experiments	September 2021

University of Bern

Experimental Methods in Development Research	Spring 2020

Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá, Colombia

Microeconomics 3	Summer 2016
Game Theory	Summer 2013 and Summer 2014
Calculus I	Spring 2009

Universidad del Rosario, Bogotá, Colombia

Microeconomics 2	Summer 2018
Mathematical Economics	2011

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Invited Presentations

2026 University of Washington, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid (UC3M), Universidad de Chile (Departamento de Economía, FEN), Universidad de Chile (Centro de Economía Aplicada, DII), University of Texas Rio Grande Valley (UTRGV), University of Tennessee, Knoxville
2025 Universidad de los Andes (Colombia), PUC-Chile, Universidad de los Andes (Chile), Universidad EIA, Banco de la Republica de Colombia, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, CIDE
2024 Universidad Javeriana, Universidad del Rosario
2023 El Colegio de Mexico, Dartmouth College, Institute for International Economic Studies (IIES), Stockholm School of Economics, University of Zurich
2022 Banco de La Republica de Colombia, University of Chicago (Harris School of Public Policy), RIPED Economic Seminars, Universidad Nacional de La Plata, Universidad de la República de Uruguay, Corporacion Andina de Fomento (CAF), World Bank, Georgetown University
2021 Columbia University (Sustainable Development Seminar), German Institute of Global and Area Studies, MIT (DEDP seminar), PUC-Chile (Economics Seminar)
2020 Northwestern University (Applied Microeconomics Seminar), Columbia University (Economics of Education Seminar), University of Bern (Economics Seminar), Universidad ICESI (Economics Seminar), Williams College (CDE alumn webinar)
2019 University of California - Merced (Economics Seminar)
2018 Center for Global Development, University of Bern, Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México, Universidad del Rosario
2017 Inter-American Development Bank, World Bank (DIME)
2016 Banco de La Republica de Colombia, Universidad de los Andes (Economics Seminar), Universidad del Rosario (Economics Seminar)

Conference Presentations

2026 AAEA Experimental Economics Section Summer Workshop
2025 Desafíos de la Educación en México (COLMEX), How should we transform school instruction to address the needs of all students? Within-class learning variability in low- and middle-income countries? (NYU), Texas Development Economics Workshop (TXDW)
2024 VIII Congreso de Economia Colombiana
2023 IIMA-RISE Research Conference on Education Economics, LACEA-LAMES
2022 XV RIDGE Forum (Public Economics), NBER Education (Fall)
2020 XII RIDGE Forum (13th Annual Meeting of the Impact Evaluation Network), E-econ of Education
2019 NBER Education (Spring), Society For Research On Educational Effectiveness (SREE), Workshop on Private Provision of Public Education, X RIDGE-LACEA Forum Public Economics, X RIDGE-LACEA Forum Labor Economics, NBER-SI (Labor Economics), LACEA-LAMES 2019 Annual Meeting, Annual Meeting Colombian Economics Conference
2018 PACDEV, RISE Conference, NBER-SI (Development)
2017 PACDEV, Western Economic Association International, Frontiers of Health Economics Research in Latin America, NEUDC, Empirical Management Conference
2016 LACEA/LAMES
2015 Southern Economics Association Conference, LACEA, PACDEV

Referee Service

Journal of Educational and Behavioral Statistics, *Economic Development and Cultural Change*, *Journal of Comparative Economics*, *The Economic Journal*, *Journal of Human Resources*, *Environment and Development Economics*, *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, *The Review of Economics and Statistics*, *American Economic Review*, *Review of Economic Studies*, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *Journal of Development Economics*, *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy*, *Experimental Economics*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *American Economic Review: Insights*, *Journal of the European Economic Association*, *Economics of Education Review*, *Health Economics*, *Nature*, *Nature Communications*, *Journal of Political Economy*, *World Bank Economic Review*, *Journal of Labor*

Economics, *European Economic Review*

AER: Insights Excellence in Refereeing Award, 2021.
Journal of Human Resources Excellence in Refereeing Award, 2023.
American Economic Journal: Applied Economics Excellence in Refereeing Award, 2025.

Proposal and Institutional Review Service

Proposals and fellowships: USAID DIV (2019, 2020, 2022, 2023); Fund for Innovation in Development (2021, 2024); CGIAR SPIA (2020); SSRC Mercury Project (2022); Riksbankens Jubileumsfond (2024); ANID/FONDECYT (2023; 2024 Regular Competition); J-PAL: King Climate Action and Learning for All initiatives (2023), Innovation in Government Initiative (2025); US–Israel Binational Science Foundation (2025); Templeton World Charity Foundation (2025); CONAHCYT: doctoral scholarships abroad (2023), postdoctoral fellowships (2024; 2023 call); SECIHTI postdoctoral fellowships (2025).
Institutional: FMCN/GANARE consultancy-proposal evaluation committee (2019); CGD publication reviews (2023, 2025); World Bank research-report review (2021); SECIHTI national journal recognition (2026).

Other Service

2025–present	Co-Chair, J-PAL LAC *Construyendo Futuros* (Growing Futures) Initiative, Guatemala
2024–2027	LACEA's Executive Committee
2026	Organizing committee for the BREAD Conference on Development Economics, Mexico City
2026	Program Committee, LACEA-LAMES Annual Meeting, Lima, Peru
2025	Program Committee, LACEA Annual Meeting, Recife, Brazil
2025	Co-organizer, ITAM/LACEA–Impact Evaluation Network mini-course on Difference-in-Differences (Kirill Borusyak), Mexico City, 26–27 September
2024	Program Committee, LACEA-LAMES Annual Meeting, Montevideo, Uruguay
2023	Organizing committee for the G^{2}LM|LIC & BREAD Conference on Development Economics in Nairobi, Kenya
2023	Organizing committee for EGAP Learning Days 13: Latin America Regional Hub Workshop
2023	Organizing committee for EGAP Latin America Regional Hub Meeting: Mexico City, October 2023
2023	Organizing committee for EGAP Priority Theme Meeting: Mexico City, October 2023
2021	Program Committee, LACEA-LAMES Annual Meeting

GRANTS

J-PAL (proposal development grant, long-term follow-ups), 2026.
Open Philanthropy, 2025.
Center for Global Development (CGD) Lead Poisoning Research Grant, 2025.
USAID (through LASER/PULSAR), 2024.
J-PAL Learning for All, 2024.
Weiss Fund, 2023.
What Works Hub for Global Education, 2022.
J-PAL King Climate Action Initiative, 2022.
J-PAL King Climate Action Initiative, 2021.
UC MEXUS-CONACYT Collaborative Research Grant - CN-20-172, 2020.
J-PAL Post-Primary Education (PPE) Initiative, 2019.
J-PAL Governance Initiative (GI), 2019.
Research Grant ES/P006043/1, ESRC, 2017.
PDEL - Graduate student research funding, UC San Diego, 2015.
LACEEP - Grant IDEA-302, Latin American and Caribbean Environmental Economics Program, 2014.

HONORS AND AWARDS

Mario Henrique Simonsen Lecture, 2026 Latin American Meeting of the Econometric Society (LAMES), Lima, Peru. Awarded to two young economists from the region for strong publications and impact.

Jacobs Foundation Research Fellowship, 2024–2026.
LACEA's Juan Luis Londoño Prize, 2023.
Investigador Nivel I — Sistema Nacional de Investigadores (SNI), 2023–2027.
Candidato a Investigador — Sistema Nacional de Investigadores (SNI), 2019–2022.
O'Gorman Scholars Program (summer visiting scholar program), Columbia University, 2022.
Chancellor's Dissertation Medal (Social Sciences), UC San Diego, 2019.
Clive Granger Fellowship for Promising Graduate Student Research, UC San Diego, 2016.
Benjamin C. Horne Memorial Prize, UC San Diego, 2015.
Lauchlin Currie Scholarship, Central Bank of Colombia, 2012–2016.
DEEWR Prize for Applied Microeconometrics, Australian National University, 2008.
Mario Galán Gómez Scholarship, Ecopetrol S.A. Bachilleres por Colombia program, 2004–2009.

SUPERVISED STUDENTS

Undergraduate Theses (ITAM)

- **David Baena Restrepo:** *Huyendo a otro infierno: Impacto del COVID-19 en el mercado laboral de migrantes venezolanos en Colombia*
- **Marcos Tonatiuh Santos de la Cruz:** *Discriminación en servicios de salud: Evidencia experimental para México*
- **Karina Itzel Gómez Medrano:** *En beneficio de la gente?: Evidencia de una provisión de libros de texto a gran escala en las pruebas de Tanzania*
- **Celia Inés Gehant:** *La transición de centrales eléctricas de combustóleo a gas natural y su impacto en la salud en México*
- **Guillermo Díaz de Rivera Laris:** *De estancias a transferencias: Consecuencias laborales del cambio de política en el cuidado infantil temprano en el caso mexicano*
- **Ilse Abigail Méndez Briones:** *Efecto de la contaminación en los resultados del COMIPEMS*
- **Jorge Enrique Méndez García:** *Impacto de los sistemas de incentivos al salario docente en el comportamiento del personal educativo en México*. Winner of the *Flecha al Aire* Prize, 2024
- **Leonela Simonne Arcos Sotelo:** *Análisis del impacto de la imposición de tarifas máximas en el sector ferroviario: Una evaluación de su efectividad en el control de precios de alimentos*
- **Adriana González Zorrilla:** *El impacto de la evaluación del desempeño docente, de la reforma educativa del 2013, en el aprendizaje estudiantil en el periodo 2015-2019*
- **Alejandro Chávez Rodríguez:** *Dormir para triunfar: el impacto del sueño en el desempeño académico*

Master Theses (ITAM)

- **Karina Itzel Gómez Medrano:** *Después del experimento: Impactos a mediano plazo de un programa de incentivos para profesores en Tanzania*

Ph.D. Theses

- **Martina Jakob (University of Bern):** *Using Field Experiments and Machine Learning to Bridge the Global Learning Gap*
- **Carla Coccia (University of Bern):** *Essays in Experimental Development Economics and Education*. Summa cum laude, 2026.

OTHER INFORMATION

Citizenship: Colombia
Languages: Spanish (native), English (proficient), Italian (basic)